

Figure 4.18 *Jam, minaret of Jam (c. 1180), distant view along valley floor. © Photograph Josephine Powell c. 1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

any association with the Shansabanis' campaigns into the north Indian plains: two unsuccessful forays took place in AH 573/1178 CE and AH 587/1191–1192 CE, and it was not until AH 589/1192–1193 CE that the Shansabanis gained a foothold in the north Indian *duab* (cf. also Chapter 1 and 6, and Volume II). Nevertheless, the *minar*'s architectural form and typology undeniably connect it to the *minar*s still standing in the Persianate world, in the territories affiliated both with the Saljuqs and the Ghaznavids – the latter particularly at the erstwhile Yamini capital. The Shansabanis' known emulation of their Ghaznavid predecessors – discussed above – strongly suggests that the Jam-Firuzkuh *minar* also served to commemorate an important military triumph. Furthermore, the presence of all of verse 13 and the beginning of verse 14 from Surat al-Saf (Q. LXI), promising imminent victory (Ar. *fath*) to those who believe in Allah, also supports the proposal that commemorating a victory was a significant – if not the principal – impetus behind the *minar*'s